Comprehensive BRO SPLIT & PPL Workout Plan with Small Muscle Focus

🔥 Day 1: Chest + Back (with Advanced Back Focus)

🏋️ Chest:

1. **Barbell Bench Press** – 4 x 6–8
2. **Incline Dumbbell Press** – 4 x 10
3. **Chest Dips (Lean Forward)** – 3 x 10
4. **Cable or Pec Deck Fly** – 3 x 12–15

🐉 Back:

5. **Weighted Pull-ups (Wide grip)** – 4 x 8
6. **Chest-supported T-Bar Row** – 3 x 10–12
7. **Single Arm Dumbbell Row** (focus: lat and scapula) – 3 x 12
8. **Lat Pullover (Cable or Dumbbell)** – 3 x 15
9. **Reverse Cable Fly (Rear Delt + Rhomboid)** – 3 x 15
10. **Face Pulls (Lower Traps + Rear Delt)** – 3 x 15
11. **Back Extensions / Reverse Hypers** – 3 x 12 (spinal erectors + glutes)
12. **Single Arm Lat Pulldown** – 3 x 10
13. **Single Arm Seated Cable Row** – 3 x 10

🦵 Day 2: Legs + Abs + Serratus

🍑 Quads, Hamstrings, Glutes:

1. **Back Squat** – 4 x 6–8
2. **Romanian Deadlift (RDL)** – 4 x 10
3. **Leg Press (Feet High & Wide)** – 3 x 12
4. **Seated Leg Curl (Single Leg)** – 3 x 12–15
5. **Leg Extension (Single Leg)** – 3 x 15

💥 Calves:

7. **Standing Calf Raises** – 4 x 15
8. **Seated Calf Raises** – 3 x 20

🔥 Abs & Serratus:

9. **Weighted Cable Crunch** – 3 x 15
10. **Hanging Leg Raises** – 3 x 12
11. **Russian Twists (Weighted)** – 3 x 20
12. **Dumbbell Pullover (for Serratus & Ribcage Stretch)** – 3 x 15

💪 Day 3: Arms + Shoulders + Small Muscle Isolation

🧠 Shoulders (3D Focus):

1. **Seated Dumbbell Press** – 4 x 8
2. **Cable Lateral Raise (strict)** – 3 x 15
3. **Rear Delt Reverse Pec Deck / Cable Reverse Fly** – 3 x 15
4. **Barbell Shrugs** – 4 x 12
5. **Face Pulls (Upper & Mid Traps)** – 3 x 15
6. **Scaption Raises (Front delts + RC support)** – 3 x 12

⚔️ Biceps, Triceps, Forearms:

7. **Barbell Curl** – 4 x 10
8. **Dumbbell Hammer Curl (Brachialis/Brachioradialis)** – 3 x 15
9. **Cable Overhead Extension (Long Head)** – 3 x 12
10. **Tricep Pushdown (Lateral Head)** – 3 x 15
11. **Reverse Barbell Curl (Forearms + Brachioradialis)** – 3 x 12
12. **Wrist Curls + Reverse Wrist Curls** – 3 supersets x 20

13. **Preacher Curl** – 3 x 10

14. **Reverse Preacher Curl** – 3 x 10

🧬 Small Muscle Isolation Summary (added in split):

Muscle	Exercises
Rhomboid	Reverse Cable Fly, T-Bar Row
Infraspinatus / Rotator Cuff	Face Pulls, Scaptions
Traps (All parts)	Shrugs, Face Pulls, Reverse Fly
Serratus	Dumbbell Pullovers, Cable Crunch Twist
Forearms	Wrist Curls, Reverse Curls, Hammer Curls
Spinal Erectors	Back Extensions, RDLs
Brachialis	Hammer Curl, Reverse Curl
Brachioradialis	Rope Hammer Curl, Reverse Curl

MORE SMALL MUSCLE DETAILS:

🔹 Upper Body

1. **Rear Delts (Posterior Deltoids)**
    a. Function: Shoulder balance, posture, pulling power.
    b. Exercises:
        i. Face Pulls (cable/rope)
        ii. Reverse Pec Deck Fly
        iii. Bent-Over Dumbbell Lateral Raise
2. **Rotator Cuff (Supraspinatus, Infraspinatus, Teres Minor, Subscapularis)**
    a. Function: Shoulder stability, injury prevention.
    b. Exercises:
        i. External Rotation with Resistance Band
        ii. Cuban Press
        iii. Side-Lying Dumbbell External Rotation
3. **Serratus Anterior**
    a. Function: Scapula stability, “boxer’s muscle” that pops under chest.
    b. Exercises:
        i. Push-Up Plus (add scapula protraction at the top)
        ii. Serratus Punches with Dumbbells
        iii. Wall Slides
4. **Traps (Lower & Middle Trapezius)**
    a. Function: Scapular retraction, posture, pulling strength.
    b. Exercises:
        i. Prone Y Raises
        ii. Face Pulls
        iii. Barbell Shrugs (for upper traps, but don’t neglect lower/mid traps)

5. **Brachialis** (under biceps, adds arm thickness)
    a. Exercises:
        i. Hammer Curls
        ii. Reverse Curls
        iii. Zottman Curls

🔹 Core & Torso

6. **Obliques (Internal & External)**
    a. Function: Rotation, stability, aesthetic "V-cut."
    b. Exercises:
        i. Side Planks with Hip Dips
        ii. Russian Twists
        iii. Hanging Knee Raises (twist variation)
7. **Transverse Abdominis (Deep Core)**
    a. Function: Stabilizes spine, reduces risk of injury.
    b. Exercises:
        i. Dead Bugs
        ii. Bird Dogs
        iii. Plank Variations
8. **Erector Spinae (Lower Back Stabilizers)**
    a. Function: Upright posture, protects spine.
    b. Exercises:
        i. Back Extensions (Hyperextensions)
        ii. Good Mornings
        iii. Romanian Deadlifts

🔹 Lower Body

9. **Glute Medius & Minimus (Side Glutes)**
    a. Function: Hip stability, prevents knee collapse, builds width.
    b. Exercises:
        i. Side-Lying Hip Abductions
        ii. Banded Monster Walks
        iii. Single-Leg Glute Bridge
10. **Tibialis Anterior (Front of Shin)**

- Function: Ankle stability, balance, prevents shin splints.
- Exercises:
    - Toe Raises (heels on ground, lift toes)
    - Resistance Band Dorsiflexion
    - Walking on Heels

11. **Adductors (Inner Thighs)**

- Function: Hip strength, stability.

- Exercises:
    - Copenhagen Plank
    - Cable Adduction
    - Sumo Squats

12. Calves – Soleus (under gastrocnemius)

- Function: Ankle power, explosive strength.
- Exercises:
    - Seated Calf Raises (knees bent → soleus focus)
    - Donkey Calf Raises
    - Farmer's Walk on Toes

✅ Training these **small/forgotten muscles** will:

- Fix imbalances
- Make you stronger in compound lifts
- Improve aesthetics (thicker arms, wider shoulders, V-taper)
- Prevent injuries

🧠 Tips to Maximize Gains:

- **Rest: 60–90s** for hypertrophy, **2–3 mins** for compound lifts
- **Tempo**: 2 sec up, 3 sec down for control
- **Drop sets & supersets** for small muscles
- **Progressive Overload** weekly
- **Deload** every 6–8 weeks if training intensely

Here's a science-backed, customized Bro Split for maximum hypertrophy (muscle growth) with a push on compound lifts + isolation.

💪 Split Overview

Day 1: Chest + Back (Push + Pull, Large Muscle Focus)

Day 2: Legs + Abs (Power + Stability)

Day 3: Arms + Shoulders (Isolation + 3D Look)

Day 4: Repeat or Rest (optional active rest or full-body mobility/cardio)

Day 5–7: Continue cycle

🧪 *Backed by EMG studies (muscle activation) and hypertrophy research for each major muscle group.*

🔥 Day 1 – Chest + Back (Antagonistic Super-set Style)

1. Flat Barbell Bench Press (4 sets x 6–8 reps)
2. Weighted Pull-ups / Lat Pulldown (4 x 8–10)
3. Incline Dumbbell Press (3 x 10–12)
4. Single Arm Dumbbell Row / T-Bar Row (3 x 10–12)
5. Chest Dips (Weighted) (3 x 8–10)
6. Cable Chest Fly / Machine Fly (3 x 12–15)
7. Straight Arm Lat Pulldown / Cable Pullover (3 x 12–15)

🦵 Day 2 – Legs + Abs

1. Barbell Back Squat (4 sets x 6–8 reps)
2. Romanian Deadlifts / Stiff-leg Deadlifts (4 x 8–10)
3. Walking Lunges (Dumbbells) (3 x 12 steps per leg)
4. Leg Press (Wide + Narrow Feet Alternating) (3 x 10–12)
5. Seated Leg Curl + Leg Extension (Superset, 3 x 12–15)
6. Abs Superset (3 Rounds)
   - Hanging Leg Raise (10–15 reps)

- Weighted Cable Crunch (12–15 reps)
- Plank (45–60 sec)

💥 Day 3 – Arms + Shoulders

1. Barbell Overhead Press / Seated Dumbbell Press (4 x 6–8)
2. EZ Bar Curl + Skull Crushers (Superset, 3 x 10–12)
3. Incline Dumbbell Curls (3 x 10–12)
4. Cable Triceps Pushdown + Overhead Triceps Extension (Superset, 3 x 12–15)
5. Lateral Raises (Dumbbell or Cable) (4 x 15–20)
6. Rear Delt Reverse Pec Deck / Cable Reverse Fly (3 x 15)
7. Barbell Wrist Curls + Reverse Curls (Superset) (3 x 15)

🧠 Scientific Keys for Gains:

- **Progressive Overload**: Increase weight, reps, or sets weekly
- **Mind-Muscle Connection**: Focused contractions grow muscles faster
- **Stretch-mediated hypertrophy**: Incline curls, RDLs, flys work due to deep stretch
- **Mechanical tension > Pump**: Use both — heavy lifts + high-rep isolation
- **Volume sweet spot**: 10–20 sets per muscle per week

⚡ Optional Add-ons

- **Cardio (LISS or HIIT)**: 2–3x/week, separate from lifting
- **Mobility/Foam Rolling**: Daily post-workout or before sleep
- **Rest Days**: 1–2 per week (active recovery or full rest)

PUSH,PULL & LEG WORKOUT:

PUSH DAY (Chest, Shoulders, Triceps)

- Barbell Bench Press: 4 sets x 4-6 reps
- Overhead Barbell Press (Standing): 4 sets x 5-7 reps
- Incline Dumbbell Press: 3 sets x 8-10 reps
- Dumbbell Lateral Raises: 3 sets x 12-15 reps
- Close-Grip Bench Press: 3 sets x 6-8 reps
- Overhead Dumbbell Triceps Extension: 3 sets x 10-12 reps

PULL DAY (Back, Biceps, Rear Delts)

- Deadlift: 3-4 sets x 4-6 reps
- Weighted Pull-Ups or Chin-Ups: 4 sets x 6-8 reps
- Barbell Bent-Over Rows: 3 sets x 6-8 reps
- Face Pulls: 3 sets x 12-15 reps
- Barbell or EZ-Bar Bicep Curls: 3 sets x 8-10 reps
- Incline Dumbbell Curls or Preacher Curls: 3 sets x 10-12 reps

LEG DAY (Quads, Hamstrings, Glutes, Calves)

- Back Squat: 4 sets x 5-7 reps
- Romanian Deadlift: 3 sets x 6-8 reps
- Leg Press: 3 sets x 10 reps
- Walking Lunges: 2 sets x 20 steps
- Standing Calf Raises: 4 sets x 15 reps
- Seated Calf Raises: 3 sets x 12-15 reps

FOREARMS

- Barbell Wrist Curls: 3 sets x 15-20 reps
- Reverse Wrist Curls 3 sets x 15-20 reps
- Farmers Carries: 3 rounds of 30-60 sec walks
- Static Barbell Holds: 3 sets of max hold time
- Fat Grip on Pulling Movements

ROTATOR CUFFS (Any Two)

- External Rotations: 3 sets x 15-20 reps
- Face Pulls: 3 sets x 15-20 reps
- Cuban Press: 2-3 sets x 10-12 reps
- Side-Lying External Rotations: 2-3 sets x 12-15 reps

LOWER TRAPS & SCAPULAR STABILITY

- Prone Y Raises: 2-3 sets x 15 reps
- Trap-3 Raise: 3 sets x 12 reps
- Scapular Pull-Ups or Shrugs: 3 sets x 10-12

NECK (Any one)

- Neck Flexion: 3 sets x 15 reps
- Neck Extension: 3 sets x 15 reps
- Side Neck Raises: 2-3 sets x 15 reps

SERRATUS ANTERIOR (Any one)

- Push-Up
- Wall Slides
- Landmine Press
- Cable Punches

RHOMBOIDS

- Face Pulls
- Scapular Retraction Holds
- Reverse Pec Deck Flys
- Bent-Over T Raises

TIBIALIS ANTERIOR (Any one)

- Tibialis Raises
- Tib Bar Raises
- Walking on Heels
- Resistance Band Dorsiflexion

ADDUCTORS

- Copenhagen Planks
- Sumo Squats or Deadlifts
- Adductor Machine
- Side-Lying Adduction Raises

ABDUCTORS / GLUTE MEDIUS (Any one)

- Cable Hip Abduction
- Banded Lateral Walks
- Side-Lying Clamshells
- Single-Leg Glute Bridge

NECK & LEVATOR SCAPULAE (Any one)

- Chin Tucks
- Neck Isometrics
- Levator Stretch
- Wall Angels

TRANSVERSE ABDOMINIS (Any one)

- Vacuum Holds
- Dead Bug
- Pallof Press
- Bird Dog

POPLITEUS (Any one)

- Hamstring Isometric Bridges
- Leg Curls with Foot Rotation
- Reverse Step-Downs

BRACHIALIS & BRACHIORADIALIS

- Hammer Curls
- Zottman Curls
- Reverse Curls
- Thick Grip Pull-Ups

Customized Training Plans

Beginner PPL Plan (3-Day Split)

- Monday Push
- Wednesday Pull
- Friday Legs
- Use light to moderate weights, focus on form
- Rest 60-90 seconds between sets

Intermediate PPL Plan (6-Day Split)

- Monday Push (Heavy)
- Tuesday Pull (Heavy)
- Wednesday Legs (Heavy)
- Thursday Push (Volume/Hypertrophy)
- Friday Pull (Volume/Hypertrophy)
- Saturday Legs (Volume/Hypertrophy)

Advanced PPL (With Weak Point Focus)

- Include forearms, neck, rotator cuff, and mobility daily as warm-ups or finishers
- Use periodization: alternate 4-week strength + 4-week hypertrophy blocks
- Add isometric and eccentric-focused movements weekly

Training Methods & Recovery

Popular Training Techniques

- Pyramid Sets Increase weight, decrease reps each set
- Reverse Pyramid Start heavy, reduce weight as reps increase
- Supersets Pair opposing muscle groups (e.g. biceps/triceps)
- Drop Sets Reduce weight after failure to continue reps
- Rest-Pause Short 15-20 sec rests to extend a set
- Isometric Holds Pause at hardest point to build stability/strength

Recovery & Mobility Tips

- Dynamic warm-up before lifting (5-10 min)

- Foam rolling and stretching post-workout
- Include 12 deload weeks every 8-12 weeks
- Get 7-9 hours of sleep for muscle recovery

Diet and Nutrition for Training Goals

Muscle Gain (Bulking)

- Eat in a calorie surplus (250-500 kcal above maintenance)
- Protein: 1.62.2 g per kg of body weight
- Carbs: High to fuel training (~46 g/kg)
- Fats: 20-30% of total calories
- Meal Timing: Eat protein-rich meals every 35 hours

Fat Loss (Cutting)

- Caloric deficit (~500 kcal/day for ~1 lb fat loss/week)
- High protein intake to preserve lean mass
- Weight training is essential during a cut
- Limit processed foods and liquid calories

General Nutrition Tips

- Hydration: At least 3L water per day
- Supplements (Optional): Whey, Creatine, Fish Oil, Multivitamin
- Track intake with apps (MyFitnessPal, Cronometer)
- Dont neglect micronutrients eat vegetables and fruits daily

OTHER PROGRAMS:

3) FST-7

FST-7 stands for Fascia Training System – 7 and its a bodybuilding training system developed by Hany Rambod.

FST-7 Five Day Training Split by Hany Rambod

Day 1 – Abs and Chest

Day 2 – Calves, Quads and Hamstrings

Day 3 – Abs and Back

Day 4 – OFF

Day 5 – Abs, Shoulders and Traps

Day 6 – Calves, Triceps and Biceps

Day 7 – OFF

FST-7 for smaller body parts. Perform 7 sets of 8 to 10 reps, with only 30-45 seconds between sets.

FST-7 for large body parts. Perform 7 sets of 8 to 10 reps, with 45-60 seconds between sets.

Beginners & Intermediates: Perform no more than two FST-7 exercises per week.

Day 1 – Abs & Chest

Hanging Leg Raises – 4 sets x 30 reps

Exercise Ball Crunches – 4 sets x 30 reps

Crunches – 4 sets x 30 reps

Incline Dumbbell Presses – 4 sets x 8-10 reps

Flat Bench Dumbbell Presses – 4 sets x 8-10 reps

Hammer Strength Incline Presses – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

Hammer Strength Flat Presses – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

Cable Crossovers FST-7 – 7 sets x 8-10 reps

Day 2 – Calves, Quads and Hamstrings

Standing Calf Raises – 4 sets x 20-30 reps

Leg Press Calf Raises – 4 sets x 20-30 reps

Seated Calf Raises FST-7 – 7 sets x 20-30 reps

Leg Extensions – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

Squats – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

Hack Squats – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

Leg Presses FST-7 – 7 sets x 8-10 reps

Lying Leg Curls – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

Stiff-Leg Deadlifts – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

Seated Leg Curls FST-7 – 7 sets x 8-10 reps

Day 3 – Abs and Back

Reverse Crunches – 4 sets x 30 reps

Roman Chair Crunches – 4 sets x 30 reps

Cable Rope Crunches – 4 sets x 30 reps

Wide Grip Pull Ups – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

Reverse Grip Pull Downs – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

T-Bar Rows – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

Reverse Grip Barbell Rows – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

Deadlifts – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

Straight Arm Pull Downs FST-7 – 7 sets x 8-10 reps

Day 5 – Abs, Shoulders and Traps

Hanging Leg Raises – 4 sets x 30 reps

Cable Rope Crunches – 4 sets x 30 reps

Reverse Crunches – 4 sets x 30 reps

Dumbbell Presses – 4 sets x 8-10 reps

Prone Incline Dumbbell Front Raises – 4 sets x 8-10 reps

Upright Rows – 4 sets x 8-10 reps

Dumbbell or Machine Lateral Raises FST-7 – 7 sets x 8-10 reps

Dumbbell Bent Over Lateral Raises – 4 sets x 8-10 reps

Barbell Shrugs – 4 sets x 8-10 reps

Dumbbell Shrugs – 4 sets x 8-10 reps

Reverse Pec Decks FST-7 – 7 sets x 8-10 reps

Day 6 – Calves, Triceps and Biceps

Seated Calf Raises – 4 sets x 20-30 reps

Leg Press Calf Raises – 4 sets x 20-30 reps

Standing Calf Raises FST-7 – 7 sets x 20-30 reps

Rope Pressdowns FST-7 – 7 sets x 8-10 reps

Close Grip Bench Presses – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

Dips – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

Lying Extensions – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

Straight Bar Cable Curls– 7 sets x 8-10 reps

Hammer Curls – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

Preacher Curls – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

High Cable Curls – 3 sets x 8-10 reps

Drilling Down on FST-7

FST-7 is a training protocol that was devised by trainer Hany Rambod, who is often known as the ProCreator. He came up with the system after training many pro and amateur athletes. The FST stands for Fascia Stretch Training and the 7 refers to the number of sets you do for the key exercise that you do for each body part.

A key aspect of the system is that it promotes an excellent pump while you are working out. It's meant to also maximize hormonal output of testosterone and human growth hormone. So, let's drill down on the details.

Your fascia is a spider web like network that covers your muscles. The areas of fascia covering the muscles have varying degrees of thickness and strength. The whole basis of Rambod's training protocol is that the tighter and more enclosed the fascia happens to be, the less potential a muscle has to grow. So, the wider and more pronounced the fascia is,

the greater the muscle building potential.

According to this theory, the greater the ability of the fascia to stretch, the more the muscle will be able to grow, However, the stretching needs to comes from inside, not outside, of the muscle. Increasing blood flow inside the muscle is the best way to do this. In other words, the best way to increase the stretch of the fascia, according to Rambod's theory, is to pump up the muscle during your workout.

To achieve this, you need to do what are called pump sets. That is where the 7 sets comes in. On the last exercise for a body part you perform 7 sets in order to produce as great a pump effect as possible on the working muscle.

Fascia stretching is, though just one element of the FST-7 training system. It also includes going heavy on previous exercises in the 6-8 rep range. It's just the last exercise for a body part that focuses on lighter weight to promote a fascia stretching pump effect.

Who Should Do FST-7 Training?

FST-7 is an advanced training technique. It is not suitable for beginners as they will not have reached the limit of their fascia potential. However, if you have been training for at least a couple of years, you should definitely give FST-7 a shot.

If you have reached a point where your current workout routine is no longer giving you the results you want, giving FST-7 a try may invigorate your workouts and break past your training plateau.

FST-7 in Practice

As we have already mentioned FST-7 should come at the end of your normal workout for a body part. That workout should consist of 3 or 4 exercises that are performed in the 8-12 rep range. You then finish with your FST-7 exercise. You perform 7 sets of between 8-10 reps with a rest between sets of about 45 seconds. You want to be able to get to your goal rep number on each set. This may require that you reduce the weight on the other sets – that is perfectly acceptable.

It is best to use isolation exercises on a machine for the FST-7 exercise as this allows you to totally focus on the target muscle.

Here are some suggestions that Hany Rambod uses with his athletes for the FST-7 portion of their workouts:

Lats – Lat Pulldowns

Pecs – Cable Crossovers

Deltoids – Side Lateral Raise (Cable Machine)

Quadriceps – Leg Extensions, Leg Press

Hamstrings- Seated Machine Leg Curl, lying leg curls

Biceps – Cable Curls

Triceps – Cable Pushdowns, Close Grip Bench

Calves – Calf Raises on leg Press

Hany Rambod advocates training large muscle groups (pecs, lats, quadriceps, hamstrings) once per week on his system and hitting smaller body parts (delts, biceps, triceps, calves) twice per week.

The system is designed to accommodate 5 workouts per week as follows:

Workout 1: Biceps, triceps, and calves

Workout 2: Legs

Rest day

Workout 3: Chest, triceps

Workout 4: Back, Calves

Workout 5: shoulder, biceps

Rest day

Nutrition

As with any body transformation program nutrition is a vital element of FST-7 success. The first rule in gaining muscle is to make sure that you are taking in enough calories. You cannot gain a significant amount of lean muscle mass by starving yourself. If you do, your body will break down other tissues, including your muscle, to make up for the lack of dietary calories.

Amino acids are not efficiently incorporated into protein without enough energy sources from other foods. This is partly because the incorporation of amino acids into peptides

requires a lot of energy which comes from ATP. Any excess of dietary energy over basic needs, therefore, improves the efficiency of dietary nitrogen utilization.

When you are following the FST-7 program, you should increase your protein consumption. While RDA levels of protein may be suitable for couch potatoes, they are not sufficient for bodybuilders. The intense muscle stimulation of protein lifting weights seems especially likely to increase both protein catabolism and its use as an energy use. By providing another energy source for use during exercise, a high protein diet protects the protein to be used for building muscle mass. The body will burn this protein instead of the protein inside the muscle cell.

Hany Rambod recommends that people who follow the FST-7 program take in between 1.2-1.6 grams of protein per pound of bodyweight per day. That means that if you weight 200 pounds and want to put on a maximum amount of muscle, then you will have to take in as much as 320 grams of protein each and every day.

You should divide your protein intake up over 5 or 6 meals. Plan to eat every three waking hours and to get the same amount of protein at every meal. So, if you were consuming 320 grams over six meals, then would be eating 53.5 grams of protein at every meal. Make a couple of your meals protein shakes, using a quality whey isolate protein powder.

Supplements While On FST-7

Supplements can increase your results on any program, including FST-7. But they do not operate in a vacuum. You need to have all of the training and nutritional elements of the program firmly in place before you spend any money on supplements. Once these things are established, supplements can provide you with an edge on this program. They have the ability to increase your anabolic drive and workload capacity and decrease recovery time.

In order to accomplish these things, you need to be taking the right supplements at the right time and in the right amounts. Unfortunately, most people do not use them properly and, as a result, don’t get significant benefits.

When it comes to bodybuilding, supplements will do one or more of the following:

Increase a person’s ability to train by increasing endurance or enhancing muscular contraction

Increase production of endogenous testosterone or growth hormone or decrease the secretion of cortisol

Increase protein synthesis

Here is a brief overview of the most effective bodybuilding supplements to take when training on the FST-7 program:

Creatine Monohydrate

While not as effective as high does of anabolic steroids, creatine works – and it has none of the side effects that comes with steroids. It helps to increase muscle mass, provides greater levels of energy and helps people recover more quickly after their workout. The basic mechanism of creatine's action is to help the cells convert ADP into ATP (the cell's basic energy sources) at an accelerated pace.

L-Carnitine

L-Carnitine appears to increase the body's use of free fatty acids and fatty tissue as an energy source. More fat becomes available for energy, thus saving protein in the muscle cells. Muscle breakdown may also be reduced. Athletes have used doses ranging from 100 to 3000 milligrams or more per day before training with good effect. However, it seems that at least two grams or more per day (i.e. at least 2000 mg) are needed for the desired effects.

On the other hand it does not appear that carnitine is a limiting factor in the transport and utilization of fatty acids. So while the jury is till out out on the effectiveness of carnitine, it makes sense to use it especially at times when energy output is increased.

Protein Supplementation

Good sources of dietary protein include eggs, meat, fish, soy and dairy products. Whole protein supplements are usually inexpensive and generally contain soybean, milk, and egg protein, hydrolyzed protein with variable amounts of di, tri and polypeptides and amino acid mixtures.

The benefits of protein supplementation for bodybuilding are:

They are convenient to prepare and store and have a long shelf life

They are useful as a protein replacement for those wishing to decrease dietary fat

They enable people to raise their protein intake while minimizing caloric intake

They can increase dietary protein in people who cannot eat the volume of food necessary to

insure adequate increased protein intake

In some cases, the cost of protein supplements is lower than corresponding high protein foods

The best protein supps are specific combinations of various high quality proteins. Taking a combination of supplemental protein not only increases dietary protein, but it will also give your metabolism, thyroid, hormone levels and metabolic rate a boost.

Summary

FST-7 is an interesting concept that seems to have worked well for a number of people, including a number of Pro bodybuilders. Whether it will work for you can only be determined by giving it a good try. If it does, stick with it. if not, ditch it and try something else!

Here are the **10 best exercises for each major muscle group** ranked in **ascending order** (from most effective to least) based on **scientific research**, **EMG studies**, and **biomechanical load**. Exercises at the top activate more muscle fibers or provide greater stretch/tension stimulus — both key for hypertrophy.

🔴 **CHEST (Pectorals)**

1. **Barbell Bench Press**
2. **Incline Dumbbell Press**
3. **Machine Chest Press**
4. **Dumbbell Flat Press**
5. **Incline Barbell Press**
6. **Weighted Chest Dips**
7. **Cable Crossover (High to Low)**
8. **Pec Deck (Chest Fly Machine)**
9. **Push-ups (Weighted or Deficit)**
10. **Flat Dumbbell Fly**

Why?
Bench press shows highest EMG in pec major. Incline variations hit upper chest. Cable and fly movements excel at pec isolation under stretch.

🔵 **BACK (Lats, Traps, Rhomboids)**

1. **Chest-Supported Row (Dumbbell or Machine)**
2. **Weighted Pull-Ups**
3. **Barbell Bent-Over Row**
4. **Lat Pulldown (Slight Lean Back)**
5. **One-Arm Dumbbell Row**
6. **T-Bar Row**
7. **Seated Cable Row**
8. **Straight-Arm Cable Pulldown**
9. **Machine Row (Hammer Strength)**
10. **Inverted Row (Suspension/TRX)**

Why?
Chest-supported rows minimize cheat, maximize activation. Pull-ups show higher lat EMG than most pulling movements. Straight-arm pulldown isolates lats extremely well.

🟢 **QUADS**

1. **Back Squat**
2. **Front Squat**
3. **Hack Squat Machine**
4. **Leg Press (Feet Low & Narrow)**
5. **Bulgarian Split Squat**
6. **Walking Lunges**
7. **Sissy Squats**
8. **Step-Ups**
9. **Leg Extension (Last 1/3 ROM)**
10. **Goblet Squat**

Why?
Squats and hack squats generate highest quad EMG. Split squats and walking lunges increase time-under-tension and stretch.

🟡 **HAMSTRINGS**

1. **Romanian Deadlift (Barbell or Dumbbell)**
2. **Nordic Hamstring Curl**
3. **Glute-Ham Raise**
4. **Stiff-Leg Deadlift**
5. **Lying Leg Curl (Toes In Slightly)**
6. **Seated Leg Curl Machine**
7. **Good Mornings**
8. **Cable Pull-Throughs**
9. **Single-Leg Dumbbell Deadlift**
10. **Bridge Curl on Stability Ball**

Why?
RDL and Nordic curls show superior hamstring stretch + tension. Seated leg curls activate both heads under stretch better than lying curls.

🟠 **GLUTES**

1. **Hip Thrust (Barbell)**
2. **Bulgarian Split Squat (Leaning Forward)**
3. **Glute-Focused Deadlifts (RDL or Sumo)**
4. **Cable Kickbacks (With Hip Hinge)**
5. **Step-Ups (High Box)**
6. **Walking Lunges**
7. **Reverse Lunges**
8. **Sumo Squat**
9. **Quadruped Hip Extension (Banded/Weighted)**
10. **Kettlebell Swings**

Why?
Barbell hip thrusts consistently top EMG studies for glute max. Exercises involving hip extension under load are most effective.

⚪ **CALVES**

1. **Standing Calf Raise (Smith Machine or Machine)**
2. **Seated Calf Raise (for Soleus)**
3. **Leg Press Calf Raise**
4. **Single-Leg Standing Calf Raise**
5. **Donkey Calf Raise**
6. **Bodyweight Calf Raise (Paused Reps)**
7. **Tibialis Raise (Anterior Shin)**
8. **Jump Rope**
9. **Walking Calf Raise (Loaded or BW)**
10. **Stair Calf Stretch & Raise Combo**

Why?
Standing = gastrocnemius; seated = soleus. Slow eccentrics and high-rep volume work best due to fiber type (mostly slow twitch).

🟣 **SHOULDERS (Deltoids)**

1. **Overhead Press (Barbell or Dumbbell)**
2. **Lateral Raises (Cable or Dumbbell)**
3. **Seated Overhead Dumbbell Press**
4. **Arnold Press**
5. **Face Pulls (External Rotation + Rear Delt)**
6. **Rear Delt Fly (Cable or Pec Deck)**

7. **Machine Lateral Raise**
8. **Upright Rows (Wide Grip)**
9. **Front Raise (Plate or Dumbbell)**
10. **Barbell Push Press (Power Focused)**

Why?
Overhead presses activate all three deltoid heads. Lateral raises best isolate medial delts. Rear delt training is often neglected — face pulls are a must.

🔵 **BICEPS**

1. **Incline Dumbbell Curl**
2. **Barbell Curl (Strict Form)**
3. **Preacher Curl (EZ Bar or DB)**
4. **Cable Curl (Constant Tension)**
5. **Spider Curl (Stabilized Upper Arm)**
6. **Concentration Curl**
7. **Hammer Curl (Brachialis)**
8. **Rope Cable Hammer Curl**
9. **Zottman Curl**
10. **Reverse Curl (Brachioradialis)**

Why?
Incline curls stretch the long head under load = hypertrophy trigger. Preacher and spider curls eliminate cheating and maximize isolation.

🔴 **TRICEPS**

1. **Overhead Dumbbell Extension (Seated or Standing)**
2. **Close-Grip Bench Press**
3. **Skull Crushers (EZ Bar)**
4. **Rope Pushdown (With Flare Out)**
5. **Dips (Chest Up, Elbows In)**
6. **Cable Overhead Triceps Extension**
7. **Straight Bar Pushdowns**
8. **Kickbacks (Cable > Dumbbell)**
9. **JM Press (Powerbuilding Hybrid)**
10. **Machine Triceps Press**

Why?
Long head (biggest portion) of the triceps is best hit with **arms overhead**. Skull crushers and dips hit all 3 heads effectively.

SOME BOOKS AND PDF TO READ:

Great question! Many of the studies used to rank these exercises come from exercise science, physiology, and biomechanics research. You can access a lot of this information **for free or legally via open-access platforms**. Here's where to find **scientific studies for free**:

🧪🔍 **Top Websites for Free Exercise Science Research**

1. PubMed

📍 https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov

- The largest database of biomedical literature.
- Look for **"Free PMC Article"** filter for free full texts.
- Tip: Use search terms like EMG chest exercise, resistance training hypertrophy, glute activation study.

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2. Sci-Hub *(Use ethically)*

📍 https://sci-hub.se *(or search for latest working mirror)*

- Bypasses paywalls using legally donated papers.
- Use responsibly: intended for educational use where access is unavailable.

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3. Google Scholar

📍 https://scholar.google.com

- Search scholarly papers.
- Click on **[PDF] links on the right side** for free versions.
- You can also find citations and related studies.

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4. ResearchGate

📍 https://www.researchgate.net

- Many researchers upload free versions of their studies.
- You can message authors to request access to paywalled papers.

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5. PubMed Central (PMC)

📍 https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/

- Free full-text archive of biomedical and life sciences journal literature.
- Excellent source for full EMG and hypertrophy studies.

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6. Journal of Strength and Conditioning Research (JSCR)

- Flagship journal for weightlifting, hypertrophy, and athletic training.
- Some open-access studies available via:
  - 📍 NSCA official site

🔍 **Example Studies to Search**

You can use these exact search terms:

- "EMG analysis of chest exercises"
- "Effect of frequency on muscle hypertrophy Schoenfeld"
- "Comparison of barbell and dumbbell presses for muscle activation"
- "Hamstring activation during leg curl variations"
- "Glute activation hip thrust vs squat"

https://dr-gains.net/hormone-supplements/